



New Linux Foundation members

Several entities joined the Linux Foundation this month, including:

- Ricoh Company Ltd, a global leader in digital office solutions, who will participate in the Linux Foundation's events and the OpenPrinting.org workgroup.
- Parallels, one of the top ten corporate contributors to the Linux kernel, and a leading provider of virtualisation and automation software for the enterprise, cloud service providers and consumers, who will participate in the Linux Foundation's workgroups and events.
- CUBRID, providers of an open source database system that is optimised for Web services to support mission-critical Internet applications. The company is joining the Linux Foundation to gain access to exclusive networking opportunities and for face-to-face collaboration with members of the Linux community.
- Professional audio equipment manufacturer, Meyer Sound Laboratories, a pioneer in audio engineering using embedded Linux to innovate in music and cinema industries.
- Consumer electronics leader LG signals formal commitment to Linux as one of its major platforms for future devices, and will participate in the Linux Foundation's events and community development efforts.
- Long-time open source contributor Collabora's team of open source development veterans will participate in the MeeGo project.
- The Planet, a leader in IT hosting, sees Linux Foundation membership as a natural step to inform its cloud computing strategy, and will participate in community initiatives and projects that support enterprise Linux.

The Linux Foundation press releases page: <http://bit.ly/daPaT3>.

Speed Dreams 1.4.0 is finally available



After 2.5 years of graphics and code development, the open-source racing game Speed Dreams 1.4.0 is available for Linux and Windows. The 3D cross-platform motorsport simulation and racing game is released under the GPL. This is the first final release since the project forked from the open racing car simulator TORCS, aiming to implement exciting new features, cars, tracks and AI opponents to make a more enjoyable game for the player, as well as constantly improving visual and physics realism. The team plans a version 2.0 release at the end of the year. Currently supported platforms are Linux (x86, x86_64) and 32-bit Windows. The Mac OS X port is 95 per cent finished. More at <http://bit.ly/bJQBoJ> and <http://bit.ly/CYCqP7>.

TeamViewer available for Linux

TeamViewer, a remote desktop tool enabling easy tech support or desktop viewing across systems, has released a full Linux client, which is free for home and non-commercial use. More at <http://bit.ly/a7uGAF> and <http://bit.ly/cQy0ma>.

Google to open source VP8 video codec

Multiple sources on the Net say that Google will soon release its VP8 video codec as open source software, and the official announcement will be at its Google I/O developers' conference this month. Once that happens, Mozilla Firefox and Google Chrome are expected to also announce HTML5 video playback support using the codec. Google has so far had no official comment about the VP8 codec it obtained in the approximately \$124.6 million acquisition of On2 Technologies in February.

The HTML5 standard does not yet specify a codec for video, and suggestions have swung between two codecs. One is Ogg Theora, which critics say is relatively inefficient though completely open source. It is actually based on an earlier On2 codec, VP3, which On2 released under an irrevocable free licence in 2001. The other is the patent-encumbered H.264 codec, managed by licensing body MPEG LA, which in February announced the extension of its royalty-free licensing for use in Web video through 2016.

Google's acquisition of On2 even led the Free Software Foundation (FSF) to urge Google to obviate the problems with Flash and H.264 video by open-sourcing the VP8 codec and using it on YouTube. More at <http://bit.ly/c6kTGV> and <http://bit.ly/cETOU9>.

